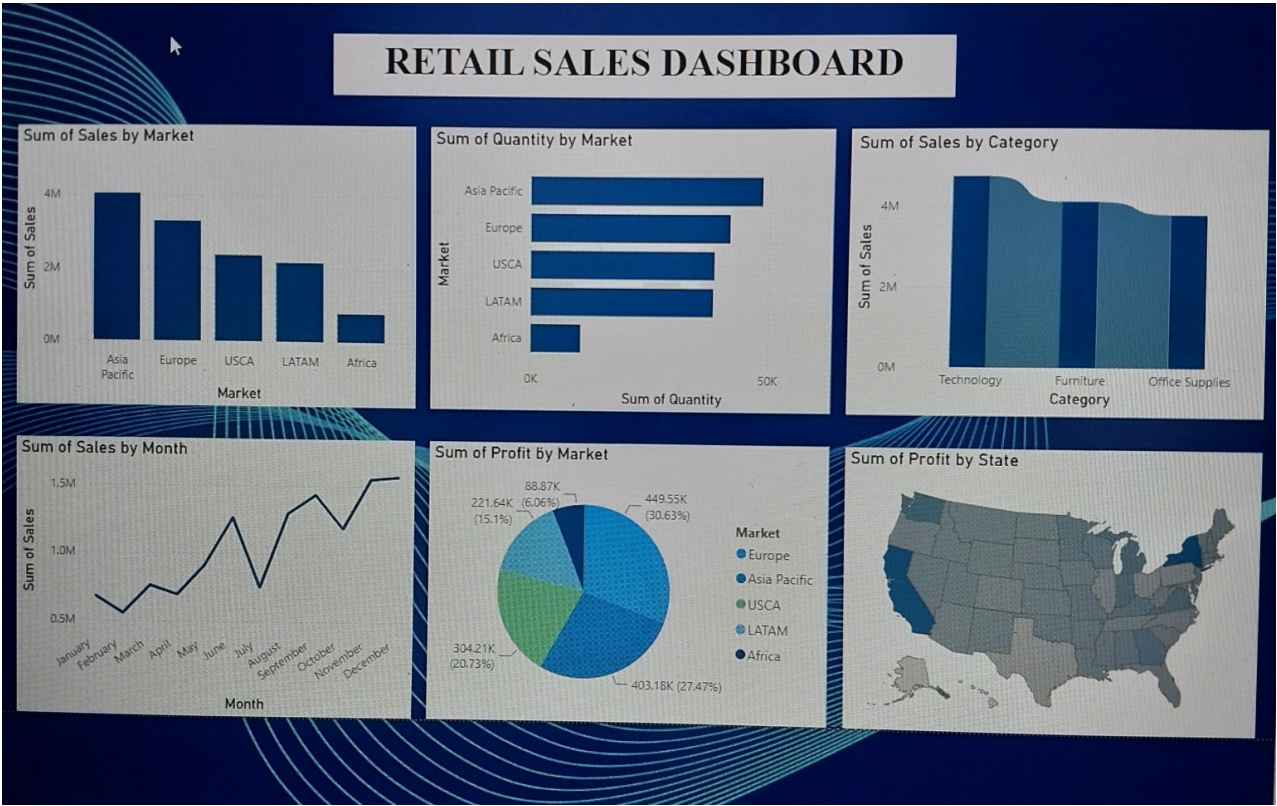


RETAIL SALES DASHBOARD

Tableau Dashboard Documentation



Purpose	This dashboard provides an interactive visual summary of retail sales, quantity and profit performance across markets, product categories, months and U.S. states.
Platform	The visualization is presented as a Tableau dashboard. The charts, geographic view and analytical layout are designed for visual exploration rather than spreadsheet-based reporting.

1. Dashboard Overview

The Retail Sales Dashboard is a management-oriented visual report intended to answer three broad questions: where sales are generated, what products drive revenue, and how performance changes over time. It combines six views in a single Tableau canvas, allowing a user to move from high-level market performance to category, monthly and state-level detail.

The dashboard uses consistent market labels—Asia Pacific, Europe, USCA, LATAM and Africa—and presents measures such as Sales, Quantity and Profit. The combination of bars, a time-series line, a profit distribution chart and a filled U.S. map creates a compact analytical view.

2. Dashboard Components & What They Show

Each worksheet contributes a different analytical perspective. Together, the views support comparison, trend analysis and geographic interpretation.

A. Sum of Sales by Market

- Chart type: Vertical bar chart.
- Purpose: Compares total sales across the five global markets.
- Observation: Asia Pacific is the highest-sales market at approximately 4.0M. Europe follows at roughly 3.2M, while USCA and LATAM are around 2.3M and 2.1M. Africa is substantially lower at about 0.6M.

B. Sum of Quantity by Market

- Chart type: Horizontal bar chart.
- Purpose: Shows the volume of units/quantity associated with each market.
- Observation: Asia Pacific has the largest quantity, close to 50K. Europe is next at roughly 43K, followed by USCA and LATAM near 40K. Africa is near 10K.

C. Sum of Sales by Category

- Chart type: Category comparison/step-style visualization.
- Purpose: Compares sales contribution from Technology, Furniture and Office Supplies.
- Observation: Technology contributes the highest sales, approximately 4.8M, followed by Furniture at about 4.1M and Office Supplies at about 3.7M.

D. Sum of Sales by Month

- Chart type: Line chart.
- Purpose: Identifies monthly movement, peaks and declines in sales.
- Observation: Sales begin near 0.65M in January, fall in February, then generally rise through June. A notable dip occurs in July, followed by strong recovery in August–September. November and December reach the highest levels, around 1.5M.

E. Sum of Profit by Market

- Chart type: Pie chart.
- Purpose: Shows each market's share of total profit.
- Visible values: approximately 449.55K (30.63%), 403.18K (27.47%), 304.21K (20.73%), 221.64K (15.10%) and 88.87K (6.06%).

F. Sum of Profit by State

- Chart type: Filled geographic map of the United States.
- Purpose: Reveals the geographic distribution of profit across U.S. states.
- Interpretation: Darker and lighter shades provide a quick visual comparison of relative state-level profit performance. The map is especially useful for identifying geographic concentration and potential regional opportunities.

3. Key Business Insights

The dashboard indicates several useful patterns. The values below are read from the displayed visualization and should be treated as approximate where chart labels do not show an exact number.

3.1 Market Performance

- Asia Pacific is the strongest market. It leads both sales and quantity, suggesting that it is an important contributor to overall business volume.
- Europe is the second-largest sales market. Its sales and quantity levels indicate a substantial and relatively balanced contribution.
- Africa is the weakest market in the dashboard. Both sales and quantity are far below the other markets, which may warrant investigation into demand, coverage, pricing or distribution.

3.2 Category Performance

- Technology leads category sales. Its sales level is visibly higher than Furniture and Office Supplies.
- Furniture and Office Supplies remain major contributors. Their combined performance suggests that the business is not dependent on a single category.

3.3 Monthly Sales Trend

- Sales strengthen toward year-end. November and December are the strongest months in the displayed trend.
- July is a significant temporary decline. The sharp drop between June and July should be examined for seasonality, supply constraints, promotions, customer behavior or data-related factors.
- Late-year momentum is strong. The recovery from July and the high November–December values may indicate seasonal purchasing patterns.

3.4 Profit Distribution

- Profit is concentrated in the top two market segments. The two largest slices represent roughly 58% of total profit together (30.63% + 27.47%).
- The smallest market contribution is about 6.06%. This is substantially lower than the other market shares and indicates an opportunity to investigate profitability drivers.

3.5 Geographic Performance

- The U.S. state map adds a spatial layer that cannot be seen in the market-level charts. It can be used to identify high-performing states, compare regions and support decisions around sales coverage, inventory allocation and market development.

4. Recommended Business Questions

- Which products or sub-categories are responsible for the strong Technology sales?
- Why is Africa producing substantially less sales and quantity than the other markets?
- What operational or seasonal factors caused the July sales decline?
- Which U.S. states contribute the most profit, and what customer/product characteristics explain their performance?
- Do the markets with the highest quantity also generate the highest profit, or are there differences in profitability per unit?

5. Tableau Implementation & Documentation

This dashboard is documented as a Tableau visualization. The following workflow describes how a dashboard of this type is typically structured in Tableau, without treating it as an Excel dashboard.

5.1 Data Preparation

- Connect the retail dataset to Tableau and verify field names, data types and geographic roles.
- Ensure measures such as Sales, Quantity and Profit are numeric and that Month/Date fields are recognized correctly.
- Assign the Market field to the appropriate categorical dimension and configure State as a geographic field for the U.S. map.
- Validate missing values, duplicate records and inconsistent category or market labels before building the visualizations.

5.2 Worksheet Construction

- Create separate worksheets for Sales by Market, Quantity by Market, Sales by Category, Sales by Month, Profit by Market and Profit by State.
- Use bar charts for market/category comparisons, a line chart for time trends, a pie chart for profit composition and a filled map for state-level analysis.
- Add descriptive titles, axis labels, data labels and legends so that each worksheet can be interpreted without external explanation.

5.3 Dashboard Assembly

- Place the six worksheets on one Tableau dashboard using containers to maintain alignment and spacing.
- Use a consistent visual theme, with a dark blue dashboard background and light chart panels, as shown in the provided design.
- Keep the dashboard hierarchy clear: market/category comparisons at the top, time/profit analysis in the middle, and geographic detail alongside the analytical views.
- Where applicable, Tableau filters or actions can be added so that selecting a market, category or state updates related views interactively.

6. Dashboard Strengths

- Multi-dimensional analysis: combines geography, time, market, category, quantity and profit.
- Fast comparison: bar charts make differences between markets and categories easy to recognize.
- Trend visibility: the monthly line chart clearly exposes peaks and declines.
- Geographic context: the U.S. map helps identify state-level variation.
- Management-friendly layout: six views are consolidated into a single reporting surface.

7. Conclusion

The Tableau Retail Sales Dashboard provides a concise overview of business performance across markets, categories, time and geography. The strongest visible themes are the leading contribution of Asia Pacific, the strong sales position of Technology, the pronounced year-end sales peak, and meaningful differences in profit contribution by market and state. The dashboard can therefore support management reporting, performance monitoring and the identification of areas requiring deeper analysis.

Documentation note

All numerical observations in this document are based on the values visibly presented in the supplied dashboard image. Where exact labels are not displayed, figures are intentionally described as approximate.